

Amazon Connect Instance Fundamentals

Course Summary

In this course, you explored what to consider before you create an Amazon Connect instance, and how to create an instance. You have also discovered instance configuration settings available after you create the instance.

Concepts and terminology

Amazon Connect is a fully-managed cloud contact center set of packaged applications provisioned in AWS. An Amazon Connect Instance is a virtual representation of your omnichannel contact center in the Amazon Web Services (AWS) cloud.

AWS users with the right IAM permissions can create and configure Amazon Connect instances in the AWS Console.

Amazon Connect virtual contact center instances

Instances



Delete

Add an instance

	Instance alias ▾	Access URL  ▾	Channels	Create date ▾	Status ▾
	 all-west-bl...	https://all-wes...	Inbound, outbound telephony	12/28/2020	 Active

Only users configured in Amazon Connect can access the console using the instance Access URL. During the instance creation, AWS users with create instance permissions have the option to configure the first Amazon Connect administrator user.

Amazon Connect

Agent Workspace

Contact Control Panel

What's new?

Quick responses is a new navigation menu under Agent Applications. Quick responses enable managers to create and manage prewritten responses to customer inquiries, helping agents solve problems more effectively. [Learn more](#)

Home

Hide the guide

Configuration guide

Now that you have Amazon Connect setup, it's easy to manage your contact center reliably at any scale. Following these steps will guide you through the basics of configuring Amazon Connect for your business.

 1. Explore your channels of communication

Claim a phone number in order to receive and make calls. [Learn more](#) [View phone numbers](#)

Engage more visitors in interactions with chat. [Learn more](#) [Test chat](#)

Increase customer engagement by enabling chat, voice and video within your communication widget. [Learn more](#) [View communication widgets](#)

 2. Set hours of operations

Hours of operation define when Amazon Connect resources, such as queues, are available, and may be referenced in flows. [Learn more](#) [View hours of operations](#)

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Instance design considerations

Before you deploy your contact center, we recommend you:

- Select the AWS Region where your instance will operate taking in consideration the physical location of your customers and agents. Design for low latency and in regulatory compliance your organization adheres to.
- Ensure you have the correct AWS Identity and Access Management (IAM) permissions for the users who will create or modify the instances.
- Plan the identity management solution that best fits your needs, the Region in which your instance is best deployed, and any assistance from AWS Partners or AWS Professional Services that might be beneficial.
- Determine the number of instances your organization requires to meet and exceed business objectives. You can deploy single instances, multiple instances in the same AWS account, or multiple instances in multiple AWS accounts. Regardless of the option you select, we recommend deploying separate contact center instances for test and production environments.

Create an Amazon Connect Instance

The AWS Management Console guides you through a 5-step process to create and configure your Amazon Connect instance settings.

First, determine the identity management settings for your instance: storing users within Amazon Connect, linking your instance to an existing directory, or using SAML 2.0-based authentication.

Second, we recommend you specify an administrator for your instance.

Third, enable telephony options by choosing whether your agents will receive calls from customers, make outbound calls, or allow for both.

Fourth, select where your Amazon Connect data is stored.

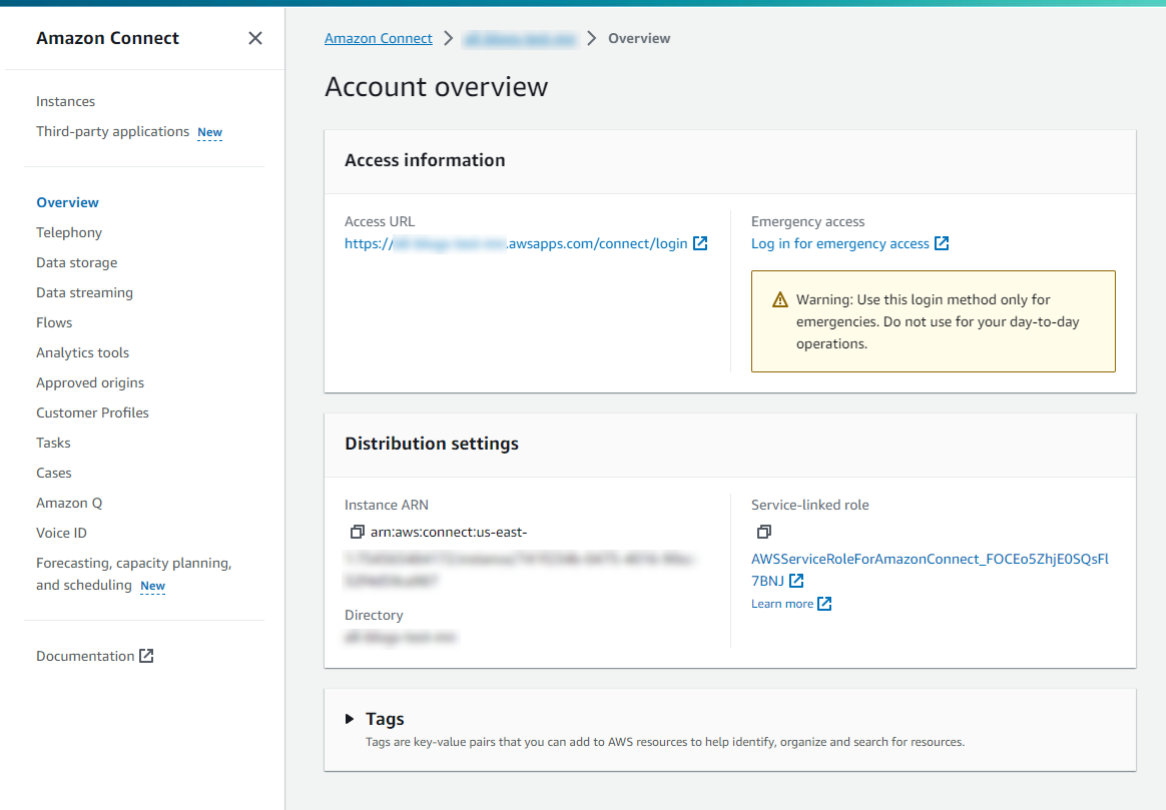
Finally, review and create your Amazon Connect instance.

Additional Configuration Options

Within the AWS Management Console, you can quickly navigate to several features and applications to modify your existing instance configurations.

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In the **Telephony** view, you are able to modify the configuration settings for receiving inbound calls, making outbound calls, and enabling early media for your agents as your contact center grows.

In the **Data storage** view, you can edit storage options for your data by select the appropriate Amazon S3 bucket, and adjust encryption options.

To power third-party integrations or custom reporting, you can enable **data streaming**. From here, you can access agent events or contact records (CTRs) to better understand real time events happening in your contact center.

In the **Flows** view, you can enhance your contact center capabilities by adding Amazon Lex bots and AWS Lambda functions to help build dynamic customer experiences.

In the **Approved origins** view you can explicitly allow cross-domain access to your instance for external applications.

Contact Lens helps you better understand sentiment trends of customer conversations.

Additional features configuration helps your contact center become more efficient. Customer Profiles, Tasks, and Amazon Q in Connect help organizations expand contact center functionality to continuously innovate on behalf of your customers.